

International Gothic

From the late 14th to the mid-15th century, the Gothic style became increasingly decorative and courtly. Art historians later called it 'International Gothic' to differentiate it from the earlier style and establish it as a precursor of Renaissance art. Primarily practised at royal courts in France, England, Italy and Bohemia, the style soon spread across western Europe. Artists created portable works such as illuminated manuscripts, which they took to different European royal courts.

Artists associated with the style include sculptors Andre Beauneveu (c.1335–1400) and Claus Sluter (c.1340–1406), woodcarvers Veit Stoss (1450–1533) and Tilman Riemenschneider; and the painters Gentile da Fabriano (c.1370–1427) and the Limbourg Brothers: Herman, Paul and Johan (fl.1385–1416). These brothers produced the best known illuminated manuscript of the time: the *Très Riches Heures du Duc de Berry*. Common characteristics of International Gothic include the use of gold, rich embellishments and colours, and elegant, graceful and rather contrived figures.



Detail from the *Wilton Diptych*, c.1390